**whether CORS is enabled. As the response contains CORS headers, the browser makes the real request and provides the response to the JavaScript app.**

**TIP** For a more detailed discussion of CORS, see *CORS in Action*, by Monsur Hossain (Manning, 2014), http://mng.bz/aD41.

The CORS specification, which you can find at http://mng.bz/MBBB, is complicated, with a variety of headers, processes, and terminology to contend with. Fortunately, ASP.NET Core handles the details of the specification for you, so your main concern is working out exactly who needs to access your API, and under what circumstances.

## *29.3.2 Adding a global CORS policy to your whole app*

Typically, you shouldn't set up CORS for your APIs until you need it. Browsers block cross-origin communication for a reason: it closes an avenue of attack. They're not being awkward. Wait until you have an API hosted on a different domain to the app that needs to access it.

Adding CORS support to your application requires you to do four things:

- Add the CORS services to your app.
- Configure at least one CORS policy.
- Add the CORS middleware to your middleware pipeline.
- Set a default CORS policy for your entire app or decorate your endpoints with `EnableCors` metadata to selectively enable CORS for specific endpoints.